

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 561

By Reneau

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Carl Elzia Levi of Chattanooga.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Carl Elzia Levi; and

WHEREAS, Carl Levi was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Carl Levi served with acumen and alacrity with the City of Chattanooga and Hamilton County for more than fifty years, having been originally hired by then-Chattanooga Mayor Rudy Olgiati for what was supposed to be a six-week tenure; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Levi served as deputy city clerk from 1957 to 1961 before becoming assistant city treasurer; he was named city treasurer in 1978 and won the respect and admiration of his colleagues and the citizens of Chattanooga during his tenure in that office, from which he took his much-deserved retirement on December 31, 2001; and

WHEREAS, seeking to continue his public service, Carl Levi was elected to the post of Hamilton County trustee in August 2002, and he served two terms in that esteemed position before ending his service in 2010, having introduced a number of cost-saving measures and other operational innovation to benefit local taxpayers; and

WHEREAS, known by many for his distinguished military career, Carl Levi joined the U.S. Army as a private in 1952 during the Korean War and was commissioned as a second lieutenant in artillery in 1958; and

WHEREAS, transferring from active duty, Mr. Levi served in various positions in the National Guard and retired at the rank of brigadier general in the Tennessee National Guard in 1987; and

WHEREAS, in 2019, the National Guard Armory on Holtzclaw Avenue in Chattanooga was named in Mr. Levi's honor to recognize his unrivaled duty to our nation; and

WHEREAS, Carl Levi leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Carl Elzia Levi, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Levi.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.